

FRANCISCO SANTOS

Leiria, Portugal

// Contacts

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// Links

[LinkedIn](#) [Portefolio](#)

// TOOLS

Unreal Engine
Unity
Blender
Figma
After Effects
Twine
Photoshop
FL Studio
Trello/Jira

// CORE COMPETENCIES

// Design

Gameplay Design
Systems Design
Narrative Design
Quest Design
Level Design
UX/UI Design

// PROGRAMMING

Gameplay Programming
AI Behaviour
Rapid Prototyping

// PRODUCTION

Leadership
Cross-functional Team Collaboration
Agile / Scrum

// TECHNICAL

Rigging
Prompt Engineering

// LANGUAGES

Portuguese - Native
English - C2

// EDUCATION

Kajaani UAS, Finland
Erasmus · GameDesign&Dev

Polytechnic Institute of Leiria
Games and Multimedia

LSD
Game Design Course

2D/3D Animation
3-Year Course

Online Courses
Rigging, Modeling, GameDev, Programing

// ACHIEVEMENTS

// GLOBAL GAME JAM

Participant & Winner
Multiple Editions

// RUN - European University

Games that can be Heard with the Eyes -
Accessible and Intergenerational Design
for Hearing Inclusion

// Leadership Academy Participant

Participated in a multi-day leadership
development program focused on ethical
leadership, teamwork, communication, and
personal growth.

// PROFILE

Game Designer and Gameplay Programmer passionate about designing engaging gameplay systems, horror experiences, and narrative-driven games. Experienced in leading international student teams and developing complete Unreal Engine prototypes from concept to playable demo.

// EXPERIENCE

Erasmus Exchange - Kajaani UAS

Finland · 2026

Game Design & Development, Kajaani University of Applied Sciences

Delivered multiple working game prototypes per semester in a high-pressure, high-output environment. Led as lead programmer on 'Once Upon a Page', a 3D narrative game built in a collaborative international team.

Developed 'One Last Score', a solo first-person stealth-horror demo with sanity, weight/greed mechanics, and AI entity.

// PROJECTS

ONCE UPON A PAGE

UNITY · KAJAANI 2026

3D Narrative Game - Lead Programmer · Team Project

Led all programming as lead developer on a team project at Kajaani UAS.

Built core game systems, player interactions, and narrative progression mechanics in Unreal Engine.

Coordinated with international designers and artists to deliver a polished playable demo under tight deadlines.

ONE LAST SCORE

UE5 · BLENDER · 2026

First-Person Stealth-Horror Demo - Solo Developer · Final Class Project

Designed and built a stealth-horror experience set in a cursed Victorian manor with a compounding risk loop: Explore > Loot > Manage Weight & Sanity > Evade Entity > Escape.

Engineered a sanity system that dynamically alters AI entity behaviour; the more the player pushes their luck, the more aggressive and unpredictable the threat becomes.

Implemented a weight/greed mechanic: heavier loot slows movement across three stages, forcing players into meaningful risk/reward decisions on every pickup.

Scripted full AI Behaviour Tree with patrol, pressure, tracker, and cooldown states reacting to player sanity in real time.

DAWNBREAKER

UE5 · 2024

Melee Action RPG - Solo Developer

Designed and implemented a fluid melee combat system with impactful feel inspired by classic action titles. Engineered challenging boss encounters with unique per-boss mechanics and adaptive player strategies.

Composed and integrated original soundtrack and SFX via FL Studio.

TRAPPED WITH IT

UE5 · BLENDER · 2024

Psychological Horror - Solo Developer

Crafted a suspenseful atmosphere through environmental design and soundscapes in a procedural horror forest

Designed phobia-based challenges targeting psychological tension as a core gameplay pillar

Implemented complex AI behaviors with unpredictable escalating encounters.

ASTRALON: ALIEN ASSAULT

UE5 · BLENDER · 2024

Space Combat - Solo Developer

Built dynamic space combat with AI behaviour, player controls, and interactive UI.

Implemented advanced UE5 graphics rendering, physics simulations, and performance optimisation.